

**"IT IS FINE TO DRAW INSPIRATION FROM THE PAST.
But replicating it just for the sake of nostalgia can arrest growth."**

LIJO JOSE, 32, AND RENY, 28, ARCHITECTS

Lijo and Reny call themselves arch (no pun intended) rebels and shudder at the day they will be permanently linked to a particular style. "For us, architecture means common sense and it keeps changing according to occasion," says Lijo Jose. Today Lijo and Reny, married since 2005 and parents of a two-year-old, stand in glorious isolation, refusing to join the nostalgia wave sweeping the state. Which is why their work has begun to make the world sit up and take notice. The house they designed for Lijo's brother in Thrissur has been selected as one of the best 50

homes from around the world by *Hiše*, a Slovenian architectural magazine in 2009. It also won them the 18th J.K. Young Architect of the Year award for 2008. Among their many achievements is a hospital in Saudi Arabia, the TKM Management Institute and MES Medical College, both in Kerala. Though all three are big projects, they find pleasure in doing off-beat buildings too. The clients can vary from large hospitals to shopping malls, enormous apartment complexes to tiny homes. Anything where they can experiment with their unique style. **by M.G. Radhakrishnan**

Role Models

An entire generation of young South American architects, like Marcio Kogan from Brazil, who are rewriting the rules of the profession.



C SHANKAR



**"LET'S NOT DISRESPECT NEW CULTURE.
The world has celebrated *Pulp Fiction*
despite creating classics like *Citizen Kane*."**

MAINAK BHAUMIK, FILMMAKER, 29

While most of India's urban youth are clamouring for US visas, Mainak Bhaumik has been applying for Indian citizenship. A US citizen, he knows that his calling is here. He is also a perfect example of the new wave that's sweeping intelligent Bengali cinema. His first film, *Aamra* (Us), released in 2006, was shot in DVD, and introduced in-film advertising to Bengali cinema. The film calls itself Bengali cinema's first urban sex comedy and was shot at a meagre budget of Rs 16 lakh. His next film *Maach, Mishti and More* (Fish, Sweets and More) looks at Kolkata's next-gen Marwaris. Bhaumik says his coming to India

was a matter-of-fact decision. He studied at the New York Film Academy, later got a degree in economics and computer science from New York's City University and even worked as a techie for sometime. Initially, he was appalled at "commercial" Bengali films. The absence of storylines and garish song and dance sequences drew only rural audiences. But it is the multiplex audience which is Bhaumik's forte. And with filmmakers like him in the fray, Bengali cinema is all set for a new dawn. **by Swagata Sen**



Early Days

He has made documentaries on indigenous facets of Bengal like the dance form Chhau and on the Patuas, a fast-disappearing artist community.

SUVASHIS MULLICK